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Chapter 11

Explorer Character Conversion



What Is Character Conversion?



Warning: Character Conversion is for the System Administrator only.

You can use the Character Conversion utility to modify the character translation configuration.

Different machines have different ways to represent the same character. So data retrieved from a Host machine must be modified before it is displayed on the PC. Occasionally, especially in international installations, the incorrect PC character is displayed for a given Host character. For example, a \$ is displayed instead of a £ or a ' instead of {.

If you experience this problem then you need to modify the character translation configuration.

When you make a connection, the system first checks if there is character translation set up specifically for the system you are connecting to. If there is, it uses this translation file, otherwise it uses the default settings specified in the INI file.

How To Establish Your Current Configuration

Step 1

Decide which connection protocol to use.

Step 2

Decide whether you need to configure individual hosts.

- If you connect to AS/400s then set up the default configuration as the configuration for the AS/400 which is connected to most frequently. Each AS/400 which has a different code page must be configured individually.
- If you connect to UNIX or NT then OEM to ANSI conversion can be configured for the individual host or for all hosts. The character translation file can only be set on a host by host basis. Any settings (other than the default of no translation at all) must be set up on a host by host basis.

Step 3

Determine the Host code page.

For example this is what to do for an AS/400:

- Logon to the required AS/400.
- Type WrkJob.
- Select option 2.
- Display job definition attributes.
- Page down twice and look for the value of the Host code page. For example, the following code shows that the AS/400 is working in EBCDIC code page 37 (which is USA/Canada).

Default coded character set identifier to 37

Step 4

Determine which Font you will use on the PC.

Please see the list of shipped translation files for an indication of which font is recommended for each country.

- Arial Monospaced and Arial Monospaced Zero Dot are ANSI fonts.
- Arial Monospaced CE is a CE (Central Europe font). This contains some characters which are not present in ANSI fonts. For example: a Latin capital letter R with acute.

For more details on the Character Translation options available for each protocol, refer to the Character Translation and Language Support section in the Technical Information.

Changing The INI File



Note: JBA recommend you comment out the OEMCONV=1 line in the INI file. This setting is for backward compatibility only.

To specify a character translation file, insert the following line in an appropriate section in the INI file and insert the fully qualified path as appropriate:

```
TranslationFile=C:\Path\FileName.Dat
```

To make AS/400 or AS/400 TCP/IP use the United Kingdom translation file:

```
[JBAS21DEFAULTS]
```

```
TranslationFile=c:\Program Files\JBASys21\E285ansi.dat
```

The Translation File can be specified for AS/400 and AS/400 TCP/IP protocols. You make the changes in either the [JBAS21DEFAULTS] section or the optional section at the end of the INI file.

You can add a section for a host at the end of the INI file. This section is optional but allows you to configure character translation on a host by host basis. Note that for UNIX or NT, a host section must be added to specify the Translation File.

Examples:

If the name of the host is MYAS400:

```
[MYAS400]
```

```
TranslationFile=C:\Program Files\JBASys21\E285ansi.dat
```

If the AS/400 is DBCS Enabled (has the DBCS Version of OS/400 installed) and has Japanese installed as either a primary or secondary language, then you must add DBCS=1 (1 signifies Japanese) to the appropriate host section.

If the name of the host is JAPANAS:

```
[JAPANAS]
```

```
DBCS=1
```

By default, the single byte (SBCS) table JbaDTab.Dat and the double byte (DBCS) tables PcsXlt.aed and PcsXlt.ead are loaded from the same directory as the INI file.

The SBCS translation file can be set by adding a TranslationFile entry to the host section in the INI file, the DBCS tables can be set by adding DBCSAtoEFile and DBCSEToAFile entries in the [JBAS21DEFAULTS] section.

Example:

```
[JBAS21DEFAULTS]
```

```
DBCSAtoEFile=C:\JapTran\PcsXlt.aed
```

```
DBCSEToAFile=C:\JapTran\PcsXlt.ead
```

Editing A Translation File

Step 1

Check with JBA Product Support to see if the Translation File which you require has already been created by someone else.

Step 2

Get a print out of the host code page and, if required, a print out of the PC code page.

Step 3

Determine which of the existing shipped translation files is closest to the one which you require.

Step 4

Take a backup copy of the file before you make any changes.

Step 5

Determine which characters need changing.

For example:

- In most EBCDIC code pages, 40 (this is in hex, in decimal it is 64) represents a space.
- In most PC code pages, 20 (32 decimal) represents a space.

Step 6

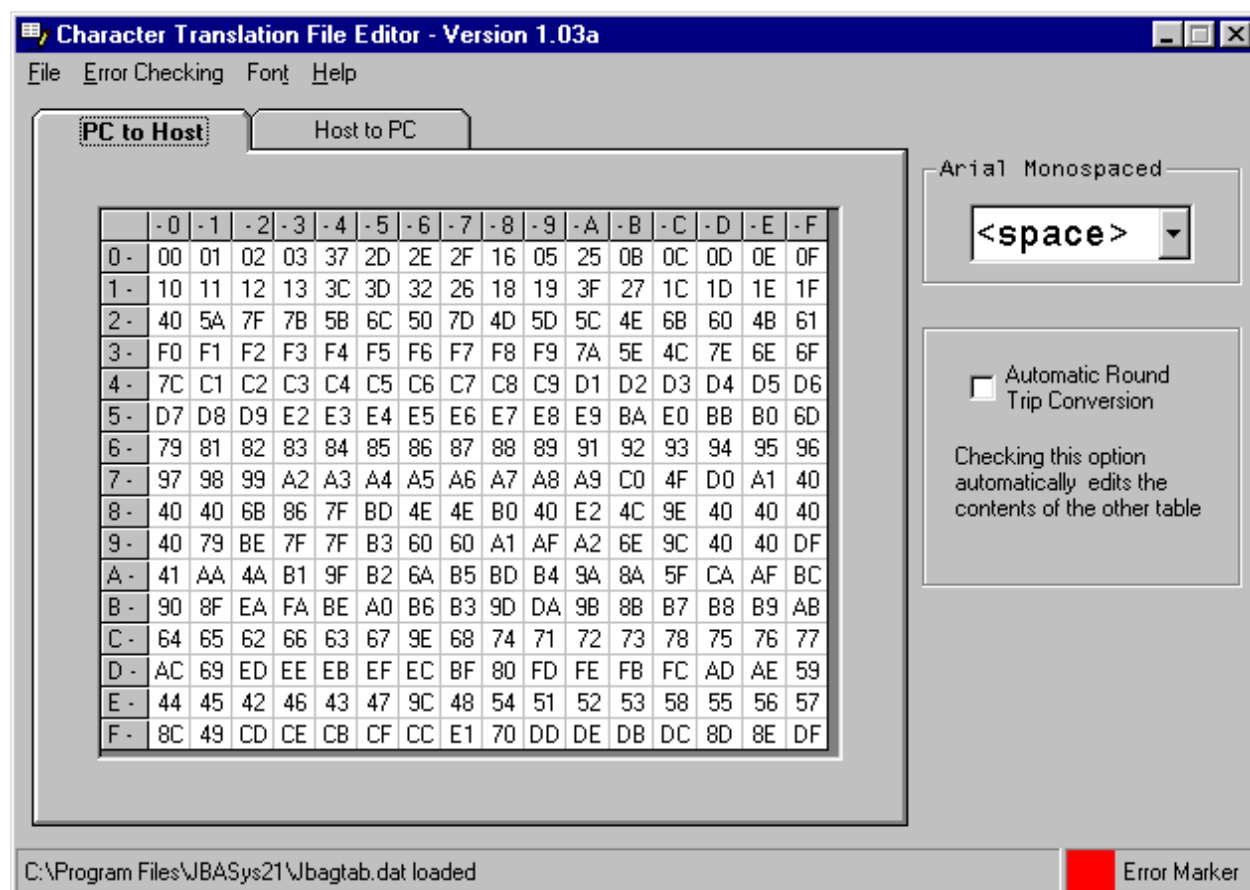
Start the Character Conversion Utility, by clicking on Character Conversion in your program list.



Note: For AS/400s, you must make sure that EBCDIC values < 40 are not sent back to the host, that is no PC value >= 20 maps to a Host value < 40.

Step 7

Open the required translation file and check that the displayed font is the font you will be using on your PC.



Step 8

Make any of the necessary changes to the file, by entering the new value in the relevant cell.



Tip: You can highlight the correct cell by selecting the required character from the drop down list.

You can either:

- Edit both the PC To Host panel and the Host To PC panel for each character you want to change.
- Or: Select the Automatic Round Trip Conversion check box and only edit one of the two panels. The other panel is automatically updated.



Note: Whichever panel you are editing, the character displayed in the Font Group box is what is displayed on the PC.

Step 9

Save the changes and exit from the Character Conversion utility.

List Of Translation Files Shipped

The name of the Translation File is often EnnnFfff.Dat where nnn represents the AS/400 code page and Ffff represents the PC font.

<u>File Name</u>	<u>Country</u>
E037ansi.dat	USA, Canada
E273ansi.dat	Germany, Austria
E277ansi.dat	Denmark, Norway
E278ansi.dat	Finland, Sweden
E280ansi.dat	Italy
E284ansi.dat	Spain, Latin America
E285ansi.dat	United Kingdom
E297ansi.dat	France
E836a936.dat	Simplified Chinese Single Byte
E870ce.dat	Latin 2, Multinational (Czech)
Jbagtab.Dat	Copy of E037ansi.Dat
Notran.Dat	A file which performs no translation
Jbadtab.Dat	Copy of E290A932.Dat
PcsXlt.aed	Japanese DBCS ASCII to EBCDIC translation file
Pcsxlt.ead	Japanese DBCS EBCDIC to ASCII translation file
PcsXlt.aes	Simplified Chinese DBCS ASCII to EBCDIC translation file
PcsXlt.eas	Simplified Chinese DBCS EBCDIC to ASCII translation file
E290a932.dat	Japan (Katakana) Single Byte translation file. (For System 21 Explorer only).



Note: UNIX code page ISO8859 is the same as code page 1252, ANSI Latin-1 so if the UNIX machine uses this code page then no translation is required. The UNIX code page ISO8859-2 should be used with the Arial Monospaced CE font and an appropriate translation table.

Character Conversion Menu Bar

The Character Conversion Menu Bar has four drop down menus:

- File
- Error Checking
- Font
- Help.

File Menu

Menu options:

New

Clears the table and font so you can start defining a new character translation table.



Note: Before defining the new translation table, you must select the font you require.

Open

Opens a different character translation table.

Save

Save the character translation table with any changes you have made.

Save As

Save a copy of the character translation table with a new name.

Print

Prints the screen.

Exit

Close Character Conversion without saving any changes.

Error Checking Menu

Menu Options:

Round Trip Conversion

This highlights all of the cells which do not convert correctly both ways and displays a message showing how many cells would not convert correctly.

Incorrect conversion is when you convert from the PC to the Host then back to the PC (or vice versa), and you do not end up with the same character as the one you started with. For example, If you set up the PC To Host code page to convert \$ to £, but the Host To PC code page to convert £ to #, when you do the round trip conversion, you would get # instead of \$.



Note: It is normal for there to be some entries which do not convert round trip. This is because there is rarely a one to one correspondence between the PC and the Host code pages.

Double Mapping

This highlights, for each value, the first cell which contains a value repeated in a later cell. It also displays a message showing how many duplications are included in this translation table.

Font Menu

Choose the font to which you set Explorer. For example, in West Europe and USA, choose Arial Monospaced, in Czechoslovakia choose Arial Monospaced CE.



Tip: If the font you use is not listed, you can edit use the Font option displayed at the bottom of the list to select the required font.

Help Menu

Menu options:

Help Topics

Displays help for this utility.

Character Conversion Windows

The following windows section gives you detailed information about using the Character Conversion utility.

Character Drop Down List

This is untitled on screen. Select the character you want to change. This highlights the relevant cell on the Grid Box so you can enter the new value.

Round Trip Group Box

Automatic Round Trip Conversion

Select this to automatically update the other translation direction as you edit this one.

For example, if you select this check box, and then change the PC To Host code page, the Host To PC code page is automatically updated to correctly reverse the translation.



Note: This Window has no buttons.